



Clicking 6K stills!

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Doodle 4 Google

Google's 8th edition of Doodle 4 Google contest invites students between class 1 to 10 to compete with their artwork for its homepage.

Agent 001

Q Mid-range gaming rig

Hi guys,

I am going to assemble a mid-range gaming PC for about 90k. I have checked out the mid-range rig given in the magazine and I wanted to clear some things up:

1. Is the budget enough for gaming, because my parents are willing to spend only this amount not even a rupee more. At first I was going for a PS4 but then I thought about the glories of the MASTER RACE PC.
2. I have always been a console gamer and this will be my first gaming PC. So for how much time will a machine costing 90k last? I mean for how much time will I be able to play the latest AAA titles until my PC becomes obsolete?
3. I have changed some of the specs, please tell me are they compatible with each other or not:
 - Intel-i5 6500 LGA-1151 3.2Ghz as the processor instead of the i5-6402P.
 - Gigabyte G1 Sniper B7.
 - GPU remains the same.
 - LG 24MP88HM for the monitor.
 - 16 GB of RAM.
4. Please suggest me a PSU for this configuration.
5. I will activate this project in mid 2017. Are there some kind of special sales or some particular time of the year when the price of the GPUs or any other accessories will drop? If yes, then at what time?

—Aryaman Upadhyay.

A Hey Aryaman,

We're glad you've chosen the path of the glorious PC Master Race. Let's tackle your queries one by one.

1. Your budget is enough to assemble a powerful gaming rig suitable for 1080p gaming.
2. The components mentioned in the mid-range gaming rig should let you enjoy AAA titles for around four to five years. Through the years, you can disable certain graphics options that don't really affect the gameplay.
3. The Intel i5-6500 is clearly a better

option than the i5-6402P. You can go for the Gigabyte G1 Sniper B7 for your motherboard. If your budget allows, then you can replace the RX 480 GPU with the ZOTAC GTX1060 Mini which will cost you around the same. For the monitor, we aren't sure whether you want a gaming monitor or not. If an IPS panel isn't necessary, then you can check out the BenQ RL2455HM (TN Panel). Pick up the 16GB RAM kits for the same model mentioned in the rig.

4. You can go for the same PSU recommended in killer rigs.
5. We are nearing towards Diwali, and you'll have ample opportunities for sales and offers on e-commerce websites.

Q Non-gaming laptop

Hey Agent 001, I want to buy a laptop of around 50k and 40k and I'm not interested in gaming. As a medical student, do you have any new and great laptop suggestions? I will definitely buy it. A humble request to you from my side.

—Dhvanil Kenya

A Hi Dhvanil,

If you aren't into gaming, then you have two options – Asus UX305CA and the HP 15-ay011tx. Both the laptops offer great performance and a good battery life around the price of 50k. On specs, the HP is better but you can go for the Asus laptop if you're looking for better battery performance and portability.

Q Gaming headphones

I'm extremely confused with which headphones to buy for gaming but they should look good and be under 6k. After hours of searching I came across two – Kotion Each G2000 and SADES A60 7.1 Surround Sound.

—Kush Khorana

A Hey Kush,

We haven't tested the headphones you've mentioned so we can't comment on them. But according to our tests, we've found the Steelseries Siberia V2 to be the best in your budget. Also, if you pay a little bit more, you can get the

HyperX Cloud II, another impressive gaming headset.

Q A core upgrade

Dear Agent001,

My desktop's current configuration is:

- Intel i5-650 (1st Gen most probably)
- Intel DH55TC motherboard
- 8 GB RAM
- NVIDIA Zotac 750 Ti GPU

I play only FIFA 15 and planning to buy FIFA 17. My desktop sometimes doesn't start and shows the wrong time (last shutdown time). I have tried changing the CMOS battery twice but problem persists. I have to wipe RAM sticks to get it started again. One of the local technicians said that the motherboard needs to be changed but it's almost a five year old 1156-socket type motherboard is hard to get in a small town where I live. I can get it online (saw a Zebronics 1156-type at Rs. 4,500 in Amazon) but the technician said it would be better if I invest in a new motherboard-processor combo. I can spare around 20,000/- for that but I don't want to do it unless it's necessary. Please suggest what should I buy.

—Tiyas Bhaumik.



AMD FX

A Hey Tiyas,

Sadly, your rig is nearing its end of life, and it would be smarter to upgrade. Under 20k, you should be able to get a decent motherboard-processor combo. Either get the Gigabyte GA-970-Gaming AMD G1 and AMD FX 6-Core Black Edition FX-6300 combo, or the Gigabyte GA-H110M-S2 and Intel i5-6402P combo. For DDR4 memory, we would suggest the Corsair Value Select CMV8GX4M1A2133C15 that you can get for under 3k. 